Into the Land

Deuteronomy 6–8 · Deuteronomy 30–34 · Joshua 1–6 · Joshua 21:43–45

The big idea: Moses preached to a new generation and died in sight of the land. Joshua led them across the Jordan, Rahab believed and was saved, and God kept every promise. Jesus is the better Joshua, who leads his people into God's rest.

Before you meet: Read

Deuteronomy 6:4–9 · Joshua 2:8–14 · Joshua 21:43–45 · Matthew 4:1–11

Open (5 minutes)

What is one promise someone kept to you that you will never forget?

Observe (fill in from the passage)

"Man does not live by _____ alone, but man lives by every _____ that comes from the mouth of the LORD." *(Deuteronomy 8:3)*

"By faith _____ the prostitute did not perish with those who were disobedient." *(Hebrews 11:31)*

"Not one _____ of all the good promises that the LORD had made to the house of Israel had failed; all came to pass." *(Joshua 21:45)*

Discuss

1. Deuteronomy says God chose Israel because he loved them, and not because they were better or bigger. Why does that matter for how you see yourself? *Deuteronomy 7:7–8; 9:6*

2. Rahab was a Canaanite and a prostitute, and she became an ancestor of Jesus. What does her story say to someone who thinks they are too far gone? *Joshua 2:8–14; Matthew 1:5*

3. Jesus answered every temptation with words from Deuteronomy. Which verse do you need ready for your own wilderness right now? *Matthew 4:1–11*

Memory verse

"Have I not commanded you? Be strong and courageous. Do not be frightened, and do not be dismayed, for the LORD your God is with you wherever you go."

Joshua 1:9

Pray

Thank God that not one of his good promises has failed. Ask him for courage for one hard thing this week, and tell someone what he has done for you.

LEADER NOTES · WEEK 24

Into the Land

Session plan (about 45 minutes)

5 min	Welcome, opening prayer, and the Open question.
10 min	Read Joshua 1:1–9 and 2:8–14 aloud together.
5 min	Observe: work through the fill-ins together. Use the answer key below.
20 min	Discuss: choose three of the questions.
5 min	Pray together. Introduce the memory verse and next week's reading (Judges 2:6–23).

Main points to land

1. God chose Israel and gave them the land by grace, not for their righteousness, and he kept every promise (Deuteronomy 7:7–8; 9:6; Joshua 21:45).
2. Jesus is the better Joshua. He passed the tests Israel failed, answering from Deuteronomy, and he leads his people into God's rest (Matthew 4:1–11; Hebrews 4:8–9).
3. Mercy was open even in Jericho. Rahab heard the same news as everyone else and believed, and she and her family were spared (Josh. 2:9–11; 6:25; Heb. 11:31).

Answer key (Observe)

1. bread; word
2. Rahab
3. word

Questions people will ask

How could God command Israel to destroy the Canaanites?
Let the question be hard. Read this week's section together. God waited centuries before judging nations that burned their children to their gods (Genesis 15:16; Deuteronomy 12:31). Mercy was open, as Rahab and the Gibeonites show. It was a one-time command for one land, never given to the church (John 18:36), and it previews the final judgment, when the only refuge is the mercy God provides in Christ.

Closing prayer

Father, you carried your people through the wilderness and kept every promise you made. Forgive us for the fears that make us want to turn back. Give us Caleb's different spirit and Rahab's bold faith. Thank you for Jesus, the better Joshua, who passed every test for us and leads us into your rest. Amen.